



Digital Assessment

Trade Resilience Plan

Phase One: Discovery and Research

Vangate Manufacturing and Automation Inc.
June 5, 2026



The Approach



Discovery & Research

- Review of current state of business, identify strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats
- Discuss initial ideas around potential growth
- Review and analyze industry and potential markets through secondary data sources
- Explore competitive market positioning
- Assess and compare your digital footprint to your competitors and identify areas of improvement

Deliverables:

- Kickoff Deck
- **Digital Assessment**
- Market Research Report
- Competitive Assessment
- Customer Segmentation

Revenue Growth

- Define your revenue growth objectives and the critical success factors to support growth
- Conduct a deep dive into your customer journey, assess your current sales and marketing activities and identify areas of improvement
- Review and align your sales process with your growth objectives
- Conduct a pricing review and develop pricing positioning strategy aligned to value, risk profile and competitive context
- Build an action plan that will help you achieve your full market potential
- Develop a roadmap for next steps for discussion and planning

Deliverables:

- Revenue Growth Strategy and Go To Market Framework
- Competitive Pricing Strategy
- Sales Process Map

Brand & Messaging Strategy

- Explore your optimal market positioning
- Develop a professional brand messaging strategy that captures your company's vision, brand personality and brand position.
- Understand your target customers and what your brand has to offer them
- Learn about your competitors and how the market may perceive your brand in comparison
- Develop messaging for up to 3 market segments
- Provide you with tools and tips to help you bring your brand to life after our project

Deliverables:

- Brand Manual
- Guide To Bringing Your Brand to Life



Suggested Timeline*

Phase		Week															
		1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
		May 18	May 25	June 1	June 8	June 15	June 22	June 29	July 6	July 13	July 20	July 27	Aug 3	Aug 10	Aug 17	Aug 24	Aug 31
Discovery and Research	Kickoff																
	Present Digital Assessment																
	Present Market Research																
	Alignment Meeting – Customer Segmentation and Competitive Assessment																
Revenue Growth	Revenue Growth Workshop (s)																
	Pricing Strategy Workshop																
	Sales Process Mapping Workshop																
	Present Revenue Growth Plan																
Brand & Messaging Strategy	Alignment meeting – Branding Strategy																
	Brand Workshop(s)																
	Present Brand Manual and Guide																
Final	Final Meeting - Review of Mandate and Key Deliverables																

*Approximate timeframe – can be adjusted depending on availability.

Note: Jason is away May 26-June 10 but the project will move forward in his absence.



Overview of the Digital Assessment

Your digital footprint plays a big part in your business development process. A well-defined digital presence ensures that visitors understand clearly what you do and why you are the best solution for them.

In this report, we do a deep dive into your online presence.

- We look at your website from a user perspective and how they navigate your site. We also look at it from a technical perspective, using several SEO tools and platforms that provide insights for traffic, keywords, competitor analysis, backlink tracking, and online visibility across search engines and AI platforms.
- We look at your social channels to see what, if any, you have set up – and how you are using your channels to build followership. We compare this information to your main competitors to see if anyone is winning on social.
- We look at your Google Business Profile and how you are appearing on review sites.

We appreciate that a digital footprint is always a work in progress. This information is provided to help you better understand what is working and where some improvements could be made to enhance your digital presence.

Agenda



01 Your Website – User Experience and Content Assessment

02 Your Website – Technical Assessment

03 External Channels

04 Competitive Digital Assessment

05 Overall Evaluation

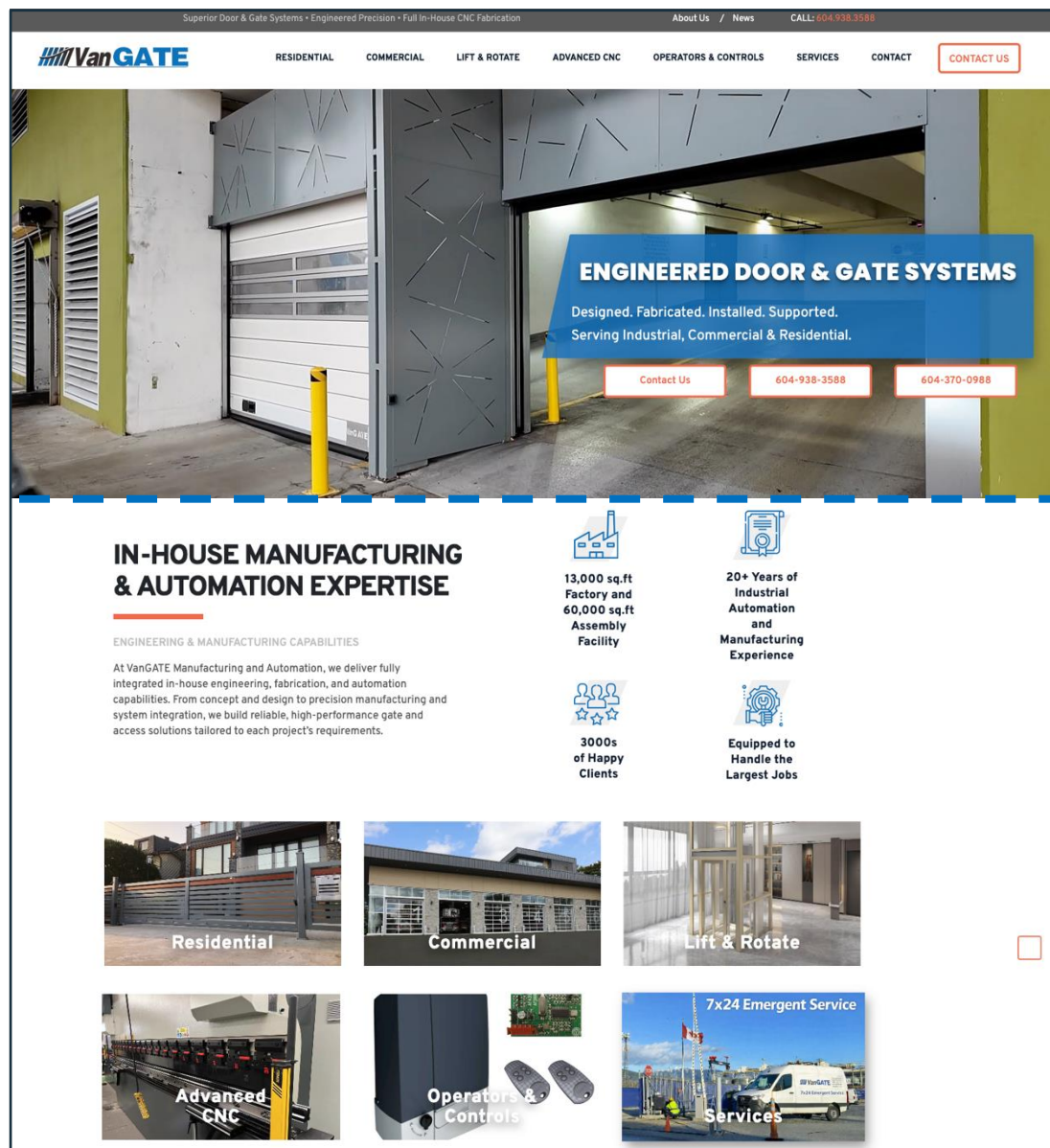
06 Next Steps



01

Website – User Experience and Content Assessment

Key Considerations for Improvements



Home Page Value Proposition

Clarify:

- Who you serve
- What makes you different
- Why customers should trust you

Site Navigation

Simplify your site navigation

- Residential
- Commercial /Industrial
- Custom Manufacturing
- Projects
- About
- Resources

Improved Segmentation

Create targeted messaging and information for your different customer types – Residential and Commercial/Industrial

Why Us

Build out your Why Us Section

Add:

- Client logos
- Certifications
- Partner brands
- Project statistics

Case Studies

Build 5-10 strong project case studies for commercial clients.

Home Page – Improved Value Proposition



- Your home page is your most important digital real estate. When a visitor lands on your site, it is important that you engage them and give them a reason to stay on your site with a clear, concise and compelling value proposition. Tell them who you are, what you do and why they should choose you.
- Your current value proposition reads:



- This is factual but doesn't answer the question why a visitor should choose you over a competitor. Consider revising this copy to read something like:
Western Canada's fully integrated gate and door manufacturer
From Engineering to Installation – Everything Built In-House
- And then support these statements with measurable proof points.

Site Navigation



RESIDENTIAL

COMMERCIAL

LIFT & ROTATE

ADVANCED CNC

OPERATORS & CONTROLS

SERVICES

CONTACT

- The current site structure appears to be organized partly by **products/services** and partly by **customer type**, which creates confusion because visitors don't naturally think that way. A homeowner isn't looking for "Operator Controls." They're looking for a driveway gate or garage door. Likewise, a plant manager isn't looking for "Advanced CNC." They're looking for a gate, door, automation solution, or custom fabrication partner.
- Think about what a visitor needs when they are searching and land on your site. Most of them are saying something like “I need a driveway gate” if they are a residential customers or “I need industrial doors” if they are a commercial/industrial customer.
- Consider updating your menu options as follows:

Solutions		Custom Manufacturing	Projects	About	Resources
Residential • Driveway Gates • Garage Doors • Home Elevators • Gate Automation • Service & Repair	Commercial and Industrial • Security Gates • Industrial Doors • Barrier Systems • Access Control & Automation • Service & Maintenance	• Lift & Rotate Systems • CNC Machining • Fabrication Services • Engineering & Design • Custom Projects	• Residential Projects • Commercial Projects • Industrial Projects	• Company Overview • Why Us? • Our Facility • Certifications • Careers	• Blog • FAQs • Downloads • Warranty Information

Defined Customer Segmentation



- As you revisit your site structure, you will have the opportunity to better segment your customers and create separate pathways for each one. This enables you to develop specific targeted messaging for each each segment.
- The information currently provided under Residential or Commercial is very product focused. This answers the 'what' question, but not the 'why'.
- Better segmentation on your website will enable you to add information here that a customer needs to know. In addition to what they might be able to purchase, it's also about developing trust and demonstrating your capabilities so that they know why they should purchase from you.



RESIDENTIAL SOLUTION

We provide complete residential access solutions designed to enhance comfort, security, and everyday living. From garage doors and entry doors to gates and home elevators, our products are engineered for reliability, safety, and seamless integration with modern homes.



Overhead Garage Door



COMMERCIAL SOLUTION

We provide comprehensive commercial access solutions engineered to support efficiency, security, and high-performance operations. From sectional and high-speed doors to rolling steel doors, parking gates, barrier systems, and dock equipment, our systems are built for durability, safety, and seamless integration within industrial and commercial environments.

Designed to meet the demands of warehouses, logistics centers, parking facilities, retail complexes, and industrial buildings, our solutions combine advanced engineering with professional installation and long-term service support.



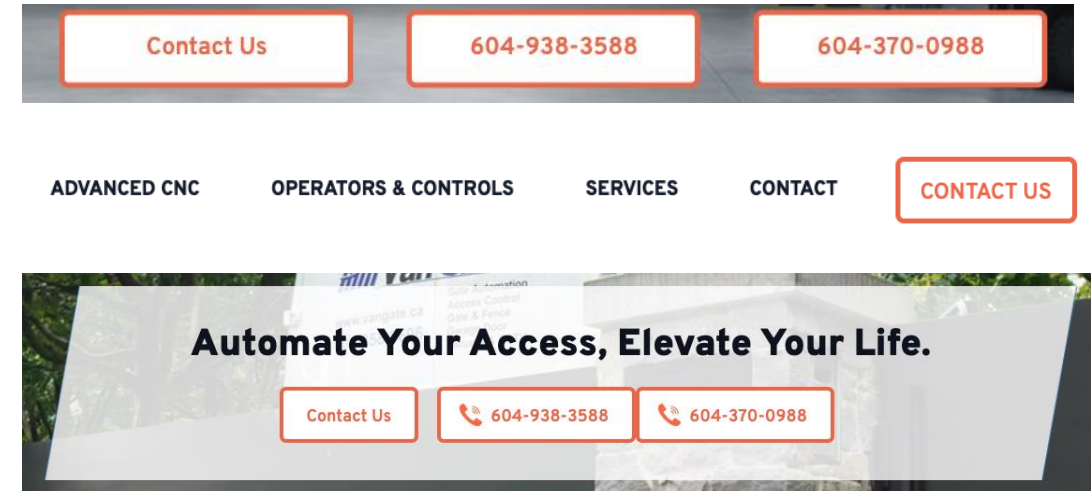
Sectional Doors

Our commercial sectional doors are designed for durability and thermal efficiency in high-traffic environments. Available in insulated and non-insulated configurations, they provide reliable daily operation while maintaining structural integrity and energy performance. Ideal for warehouses, service bays, industrial buildings, and commercial facilities requiring dependable overhead access solutions.

Improved Calls to Action



- Words are important. Most of your calls to action are “Contact Us” which doesn’t create urgency.
- Add stronger conversion options like:
 - Residential
 - Request a quote
 - Book a site visit
 - Download our brochure
 - Commercial
 - Speak with an Technical Specialist
 - Request Project Consultation
 - Submit Drawings for Review



Commercial Buyers Need Evidence



- Commercial buyers purchase based on prior experience – they need evidence that you know how to do what they need you to do.
- A case study is a great way to demonstrate your capabilities. Create a case study for 5-10 of your major projects that showcase your commercial capabilities. Each case study could include things like:
 - Project Name
 - Industry
 - Scope
 - Challenge
 - Solution
 - Photos
- It would be also be good to show information on industry associations, certifications and operational metrics and KPI's for your commercial customers.

Why Us



- While there is lots of information throughout the site that helps to answer the question why a visitor should choose you over a competitor, it would be stronger if this info was grouped together and better organized.
- In one Why Us section, you could include things like
 - Industry memberships, affiliations and certifications
 - Safety programs and certifications,
 - Years in business, years of experience
 - Company vision and values
 - Team culture
 - Project counts
 - Customer logos
 - Testimonials

Other Considerations: Relaunch your blog



- Adding a blog to a website is excellent way to provide more content and improve your SEO.
- In your case, your blog is a great source of information but its more than five years old.
- Consider relaunching your blog and building more content that will drive organic traffic and help educate your buyers.
- Topics could include those things that people are commonly searching for – for example:
 - Swing vs cantilever gate
 - High speed door ROI
 - Commercial gate maintenance
 - Security gate requirements
- Brainstorm with your team and create a pipeline; then create a schedule for development and posting. You may want to consider AI to help with initial drafts.

Other Considerations: Add a Careers section



- The ability to attract new employees will be a critical element of your growth plan. To that end, consider a Careers page.
- A Careers page should do more than just list open positions; this is an opportunity to showcase your employer brand and attract candidates for future recruitment.
- It could include things like:
 - Your company mission, vision and values
 - Your culture – and what an employee can expect to experience
 - High level overview of compensation and benefits information
 - Details around training and development opportunities
 - Bios of key team members, possibly with employee testimonials
 - FAQ for things like the interview process, onboarding, etc.

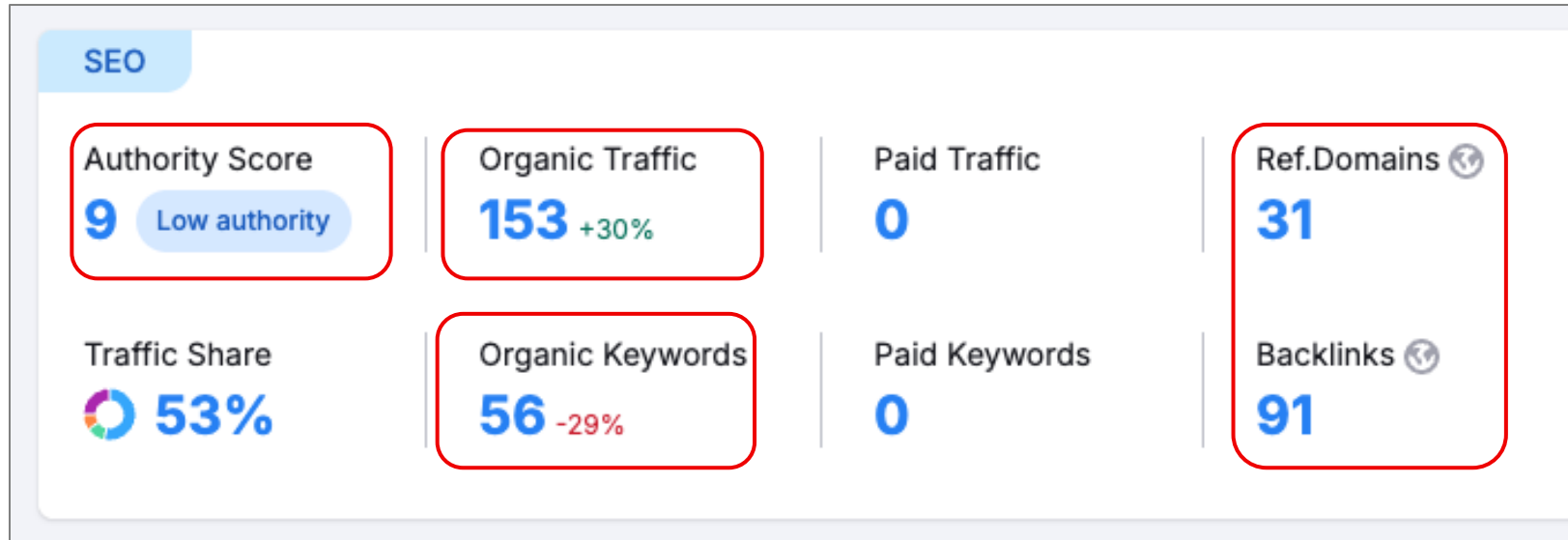


02

Technical Website Assessment



Website Health: SEMRush Dashboard



We used Semrush to run a quick overview of your website.

Observations

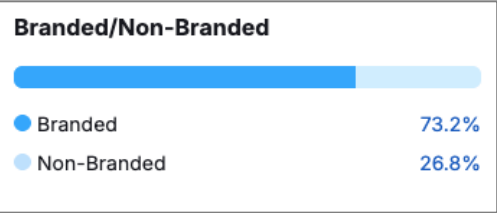
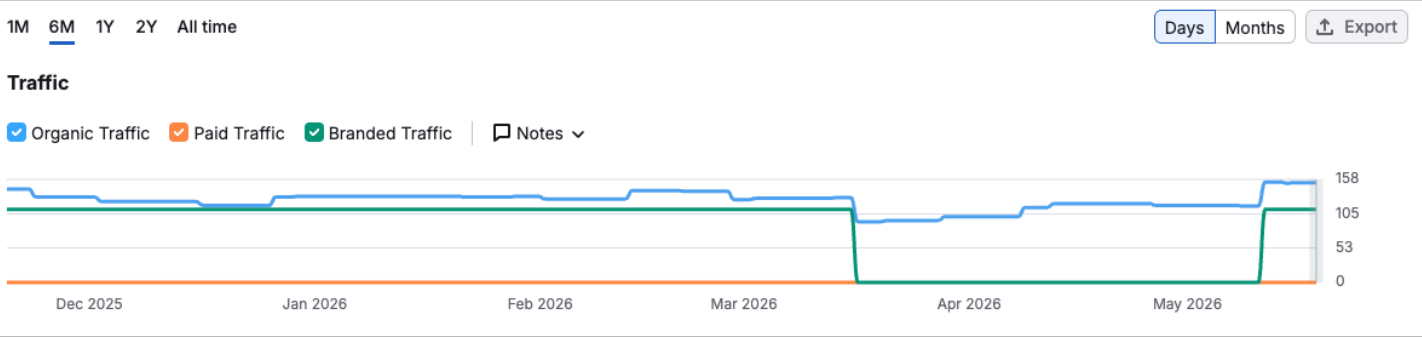
- Your Authority Score is 9. The calculation is based on three things: your organic traffic, the quality and quantity of your backlinks and spam factors. Typically, we see smaller businesses with well-optimized sites ranking in the 15-20 range. Your low authority score ranking indicates that your site is not fully optimized to be search engine friendly at the moment.
- You had 153 visits to your website with 56 keywords being used for searches.
- Referring domains are the number of unique websites linking to you; backlinks are the total number of links to your website. You have only 31 referring domains and 91 backlinks, which accounts for a large part of your low authority score ranking.

Recommendations

- When you update your website, you will need to add more SEO rich content and work with your website provider to improve your backlink strategy.

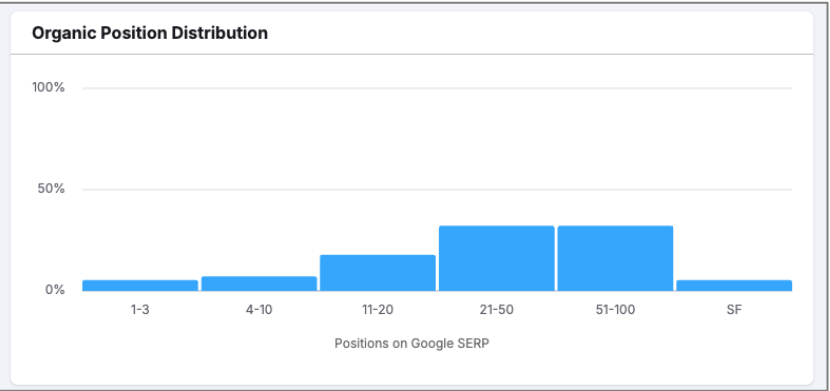
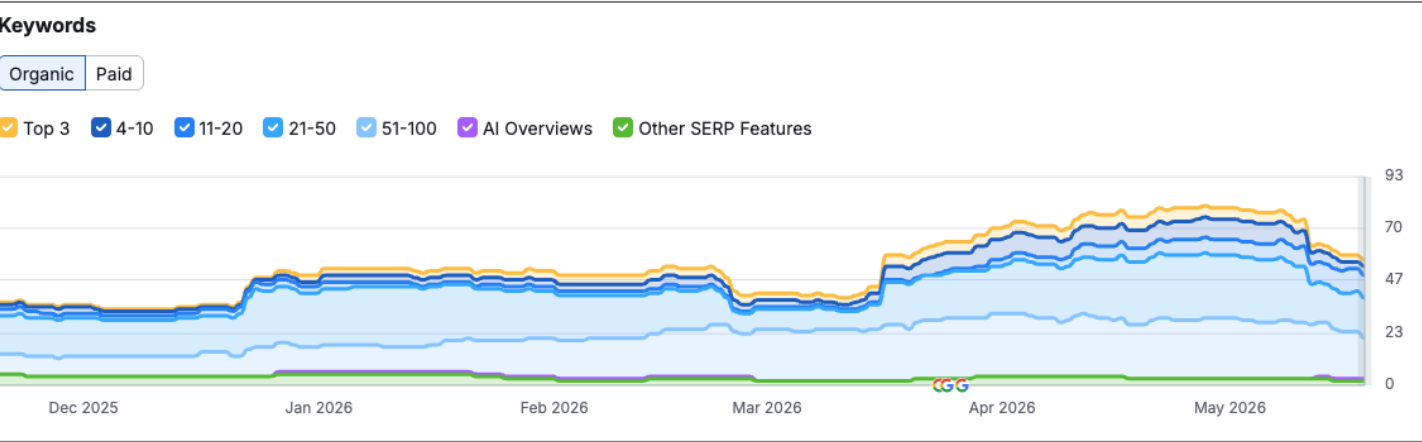
Source: Semrush

Domain Overview – Traffic and Keywords



Distribution by Country

Countries	Traffic	Keywords
Worldwide	160	82
CA	153	56
IL	4	1
ES	2	1
Other	1	24



Top Organic Keywords 53

Keyword	Intent	Pos.	Volume	CPC (U...)	Traffic
vangate manufacturing and automation inc	N	1	140	0.00	73.20
automatic gate supplier	C	1	110	0.00	17.64
gates and automation	I	2	50	1.80	3.92
automatic gate suppliers	C	1	50	0.00	3.92
garage door with door	C	16	1K	2.05	0.65

View details

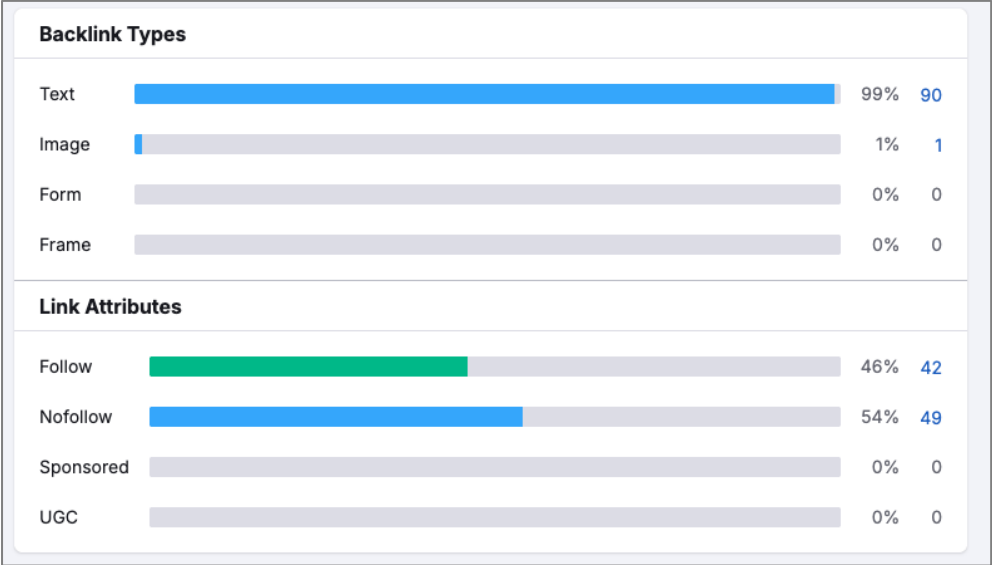
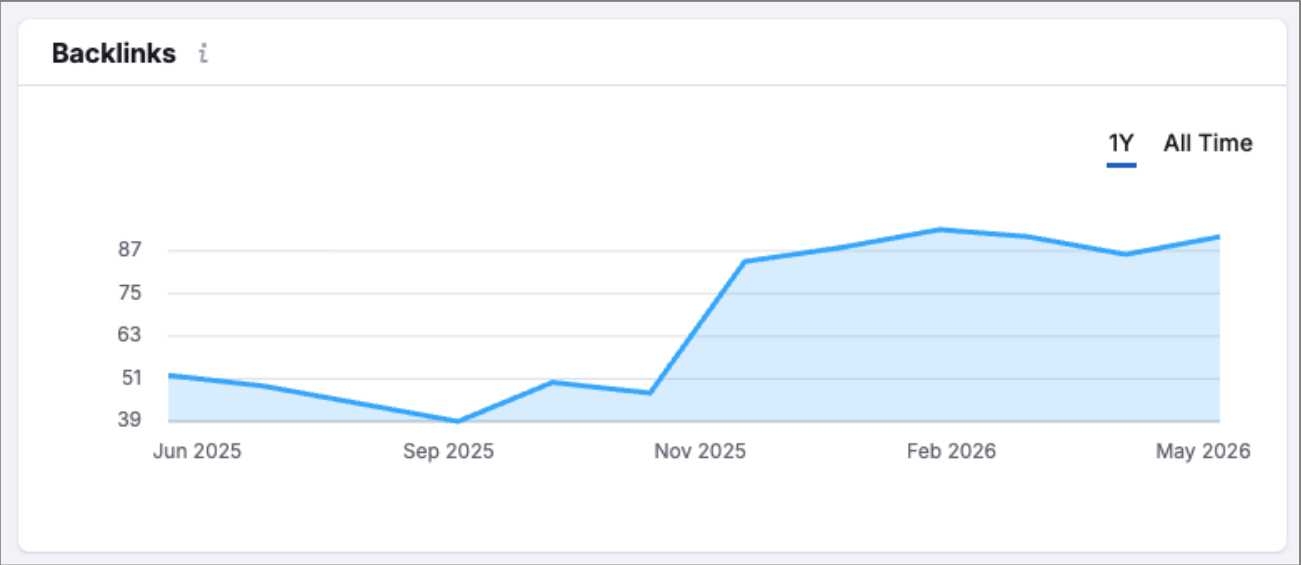
Observations

- You had 153 visits to your site in the reporting period. All of that traffic was organic (no paid SEM) mostly from Canada.
- About three quarters of that traffic was branded, meaning people were searching specifically for your business; the balance was unbranded, meaning a search was done for a type of product or service, not a specific company.
- Of the 56 keywords used in search, only a small percentages placed you at the top of the search results. The majority of placed you between 21-100 in search results. Your best keywords are you business name (branded search) and automatic gate supplier (unbranded search).

Recommendations

- You need more SEO rich content to be able to be found more prominently in the search results.

Backlinks



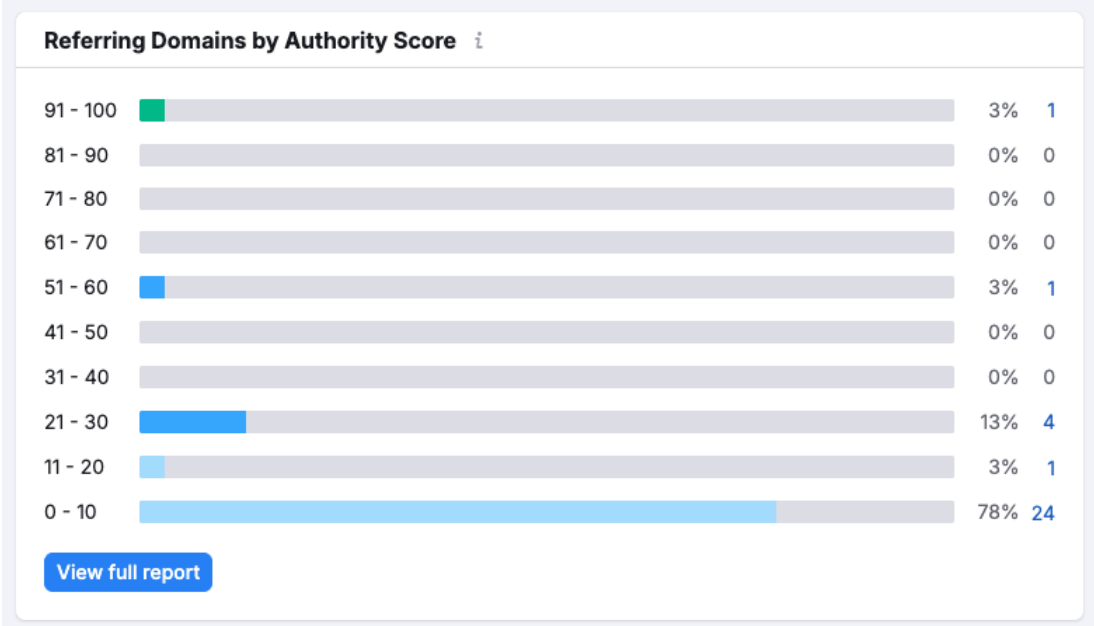
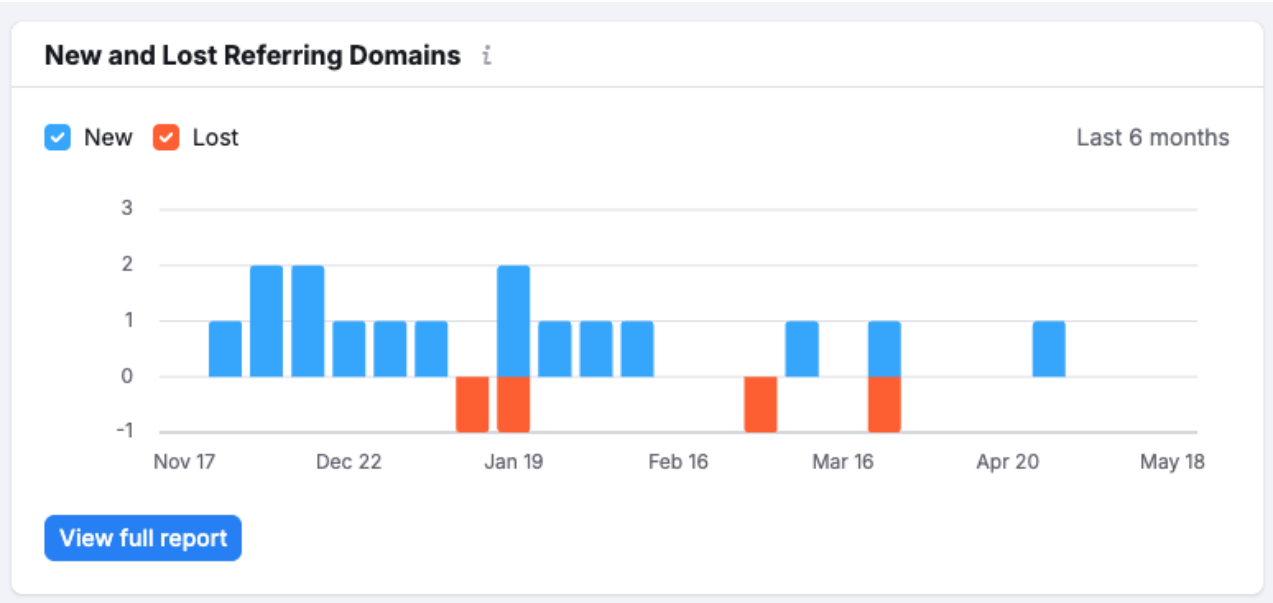
Observations

- You have increased the number of backlinks for your site over the last twelve months.
- Almost all of your links are text, which is pretty typical.
- 46% of your links are follow – these are valuable for SEO.

Recommendations

- Work with your webmaster to develop an improved backlink strategy.

Backlinks



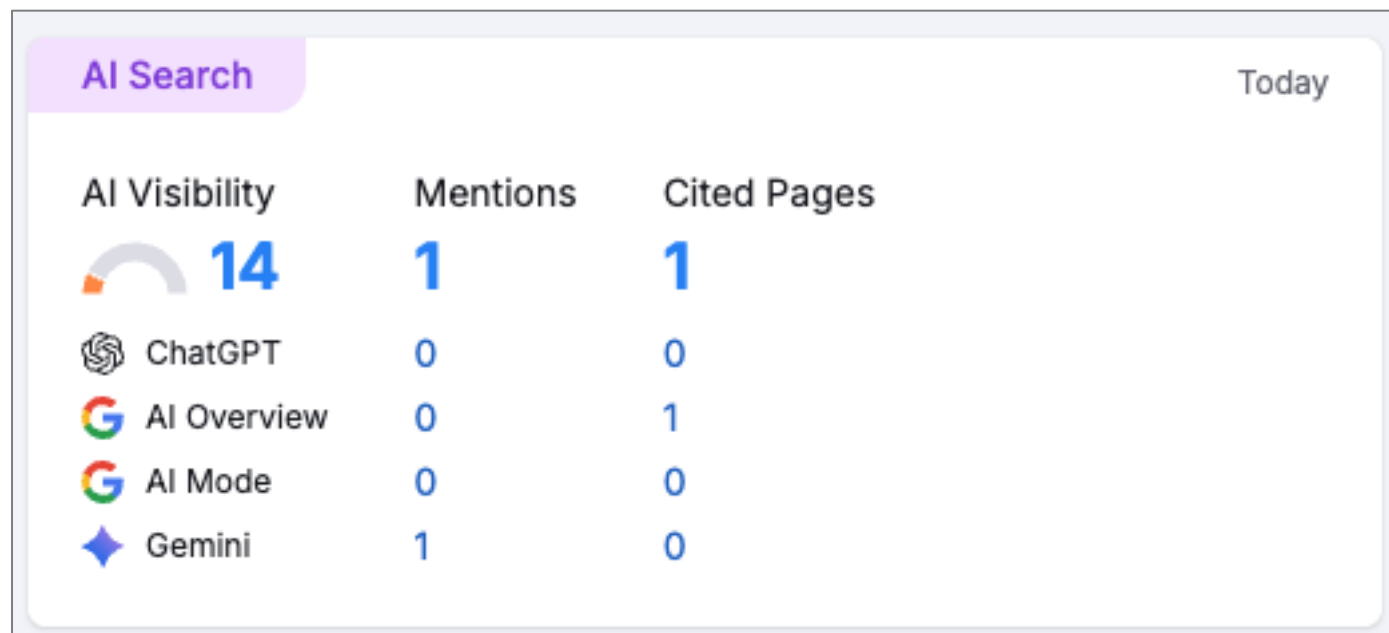
Observations

- You have increased the number of referring domains for your site over the last 12 months.
- The majority of your referring domains have relatively low authority scores (between 1-10).

Recommendations

- Work with your webmaster to develop an improved backlink strategy.

AI Search – AI Visibility Score



Observations

- As more people start to use AI, it is important that your website is on the radar for AI platforms. This indicates that Google AI and Gemini have mentioned your business or cited one of your webpages in its results, giving you an AI visibility score of 14.

Recommendations

- There is some work to do here to further improve this score. Improving your SEO for your website will also improve your AI Visibility score.

Website Health: BDC Website Assessment Tool

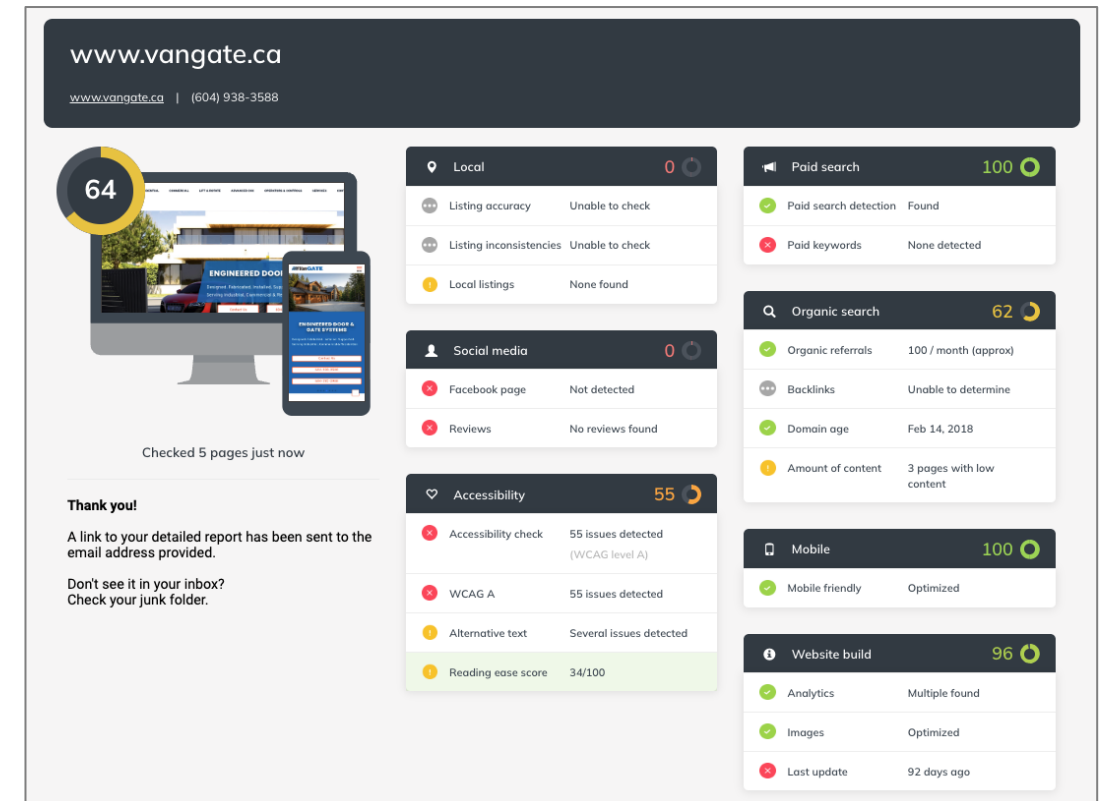


Observations

- ➔ We ran your website through the BDC Web Assessment tool. It received a 64/100 rating, indicating that there is some work to do.
- ➔ Part of that low score is due to a lack of social presence and no links from your website to any of your social channels.
- ➔ In addition, there are some technical issues around local listing info, accessibility and organic search functionality.
- ➔ On the plus side, your website has analytics installed, uses paid search and is well optimized for mobile phones.

Recommendations

- ➔ When you next update your website, show this report to your website partner.
- ➔ Ensure that any of your listings appear that in any online directory are accurate and complete.
- ➔ For now, add your Linked In social channel to your website. As you set up other channels and develop a content strategy, this can be updated.
- ➔ Review and address the accessibility issues.
- ➔ Focus on more SEO rich content and develop a backlink strategy.



Website Health: Google Lighthouse



Desktop:



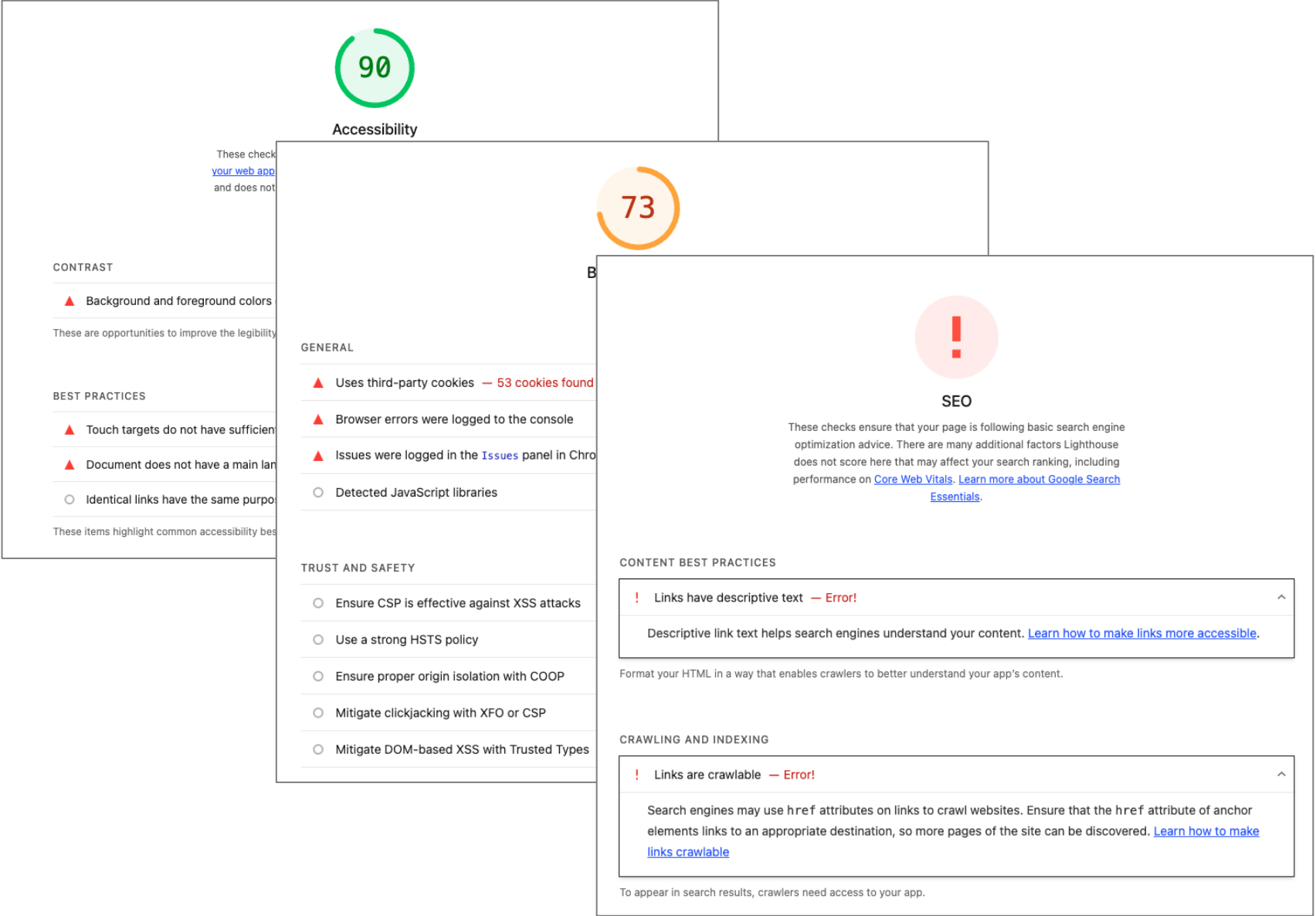
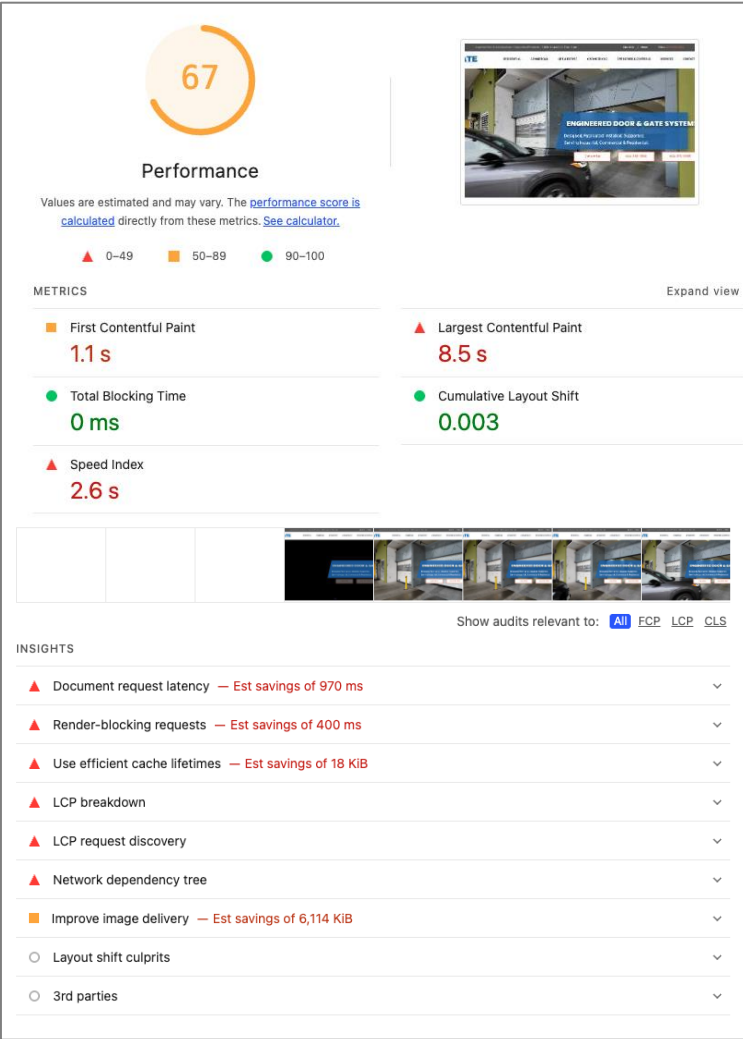
Mobile:



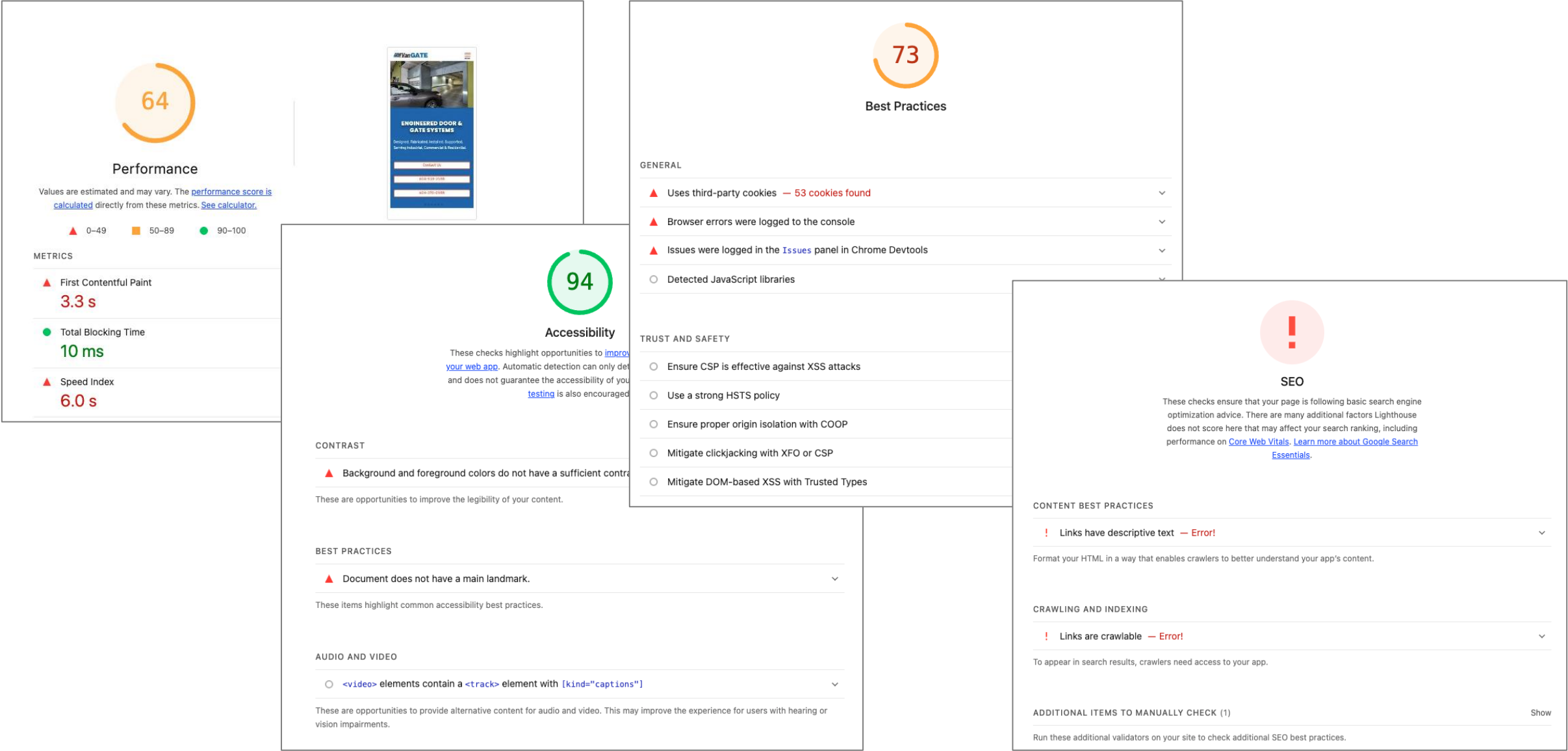
Observations

- ➔ We also ran your website through Google Lighthouse to generate reports for both your desktop and mobile websites.
- ➔ It generates a report with ratings in four areas: Performance, Accessibility, Best Practices and SEO.
- ➔ Once you install Google lighthouse, you can click on the link to see more detail.
 - Desktop - [Google Lighthouse Desktop](#)
 - Mobile - [Google Lighthouse Mobile](#)

Website Health: Google Lighthouse (Desktop)



Website Health: Google Lighthouse (Mobile)





03

External Channels



Google Business Profile

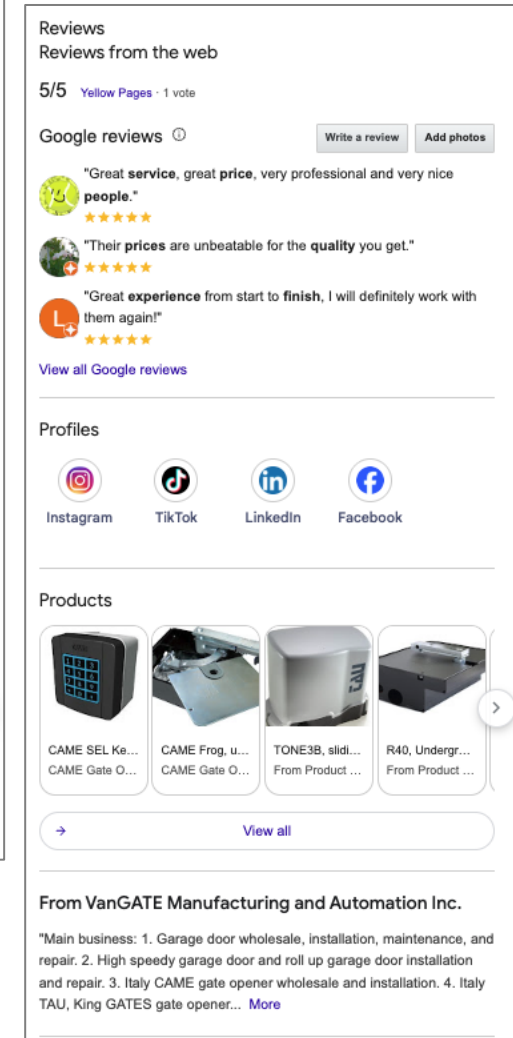
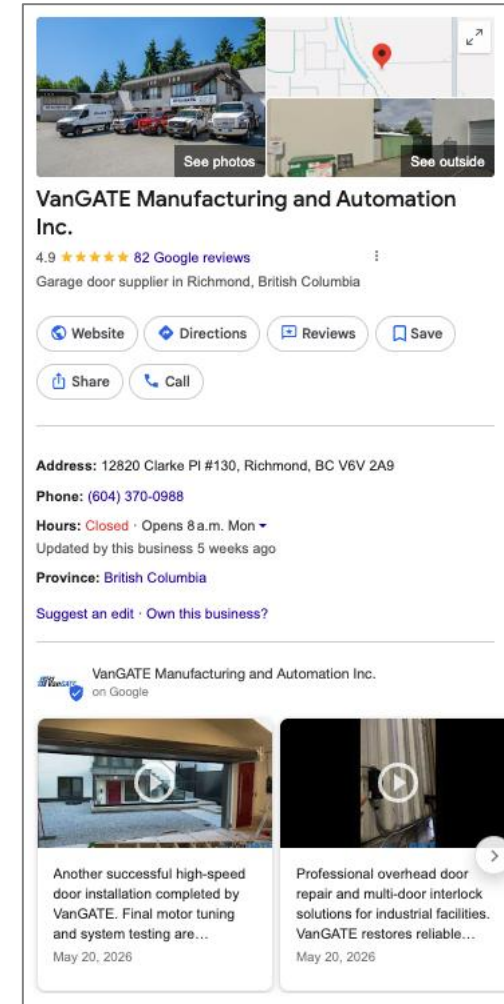
As a business, you want to provide information about who you are, what you offer and how your products and services will benefit a customer. Most prospects will check you out online at some point in their customer journey.

The first thing they will likely see when do an online search for you is your Google Business Profile.

- ➔ Google Business Profile (GBP), formerly Google My Business, enables you to have a prominent position on the search results page.
- ➔ It provides a snapshot of your business with links to things like your website, the map and directions, your Google reviews and your contact information
- ➔ It will also support your SEO rankings.

Best practices:

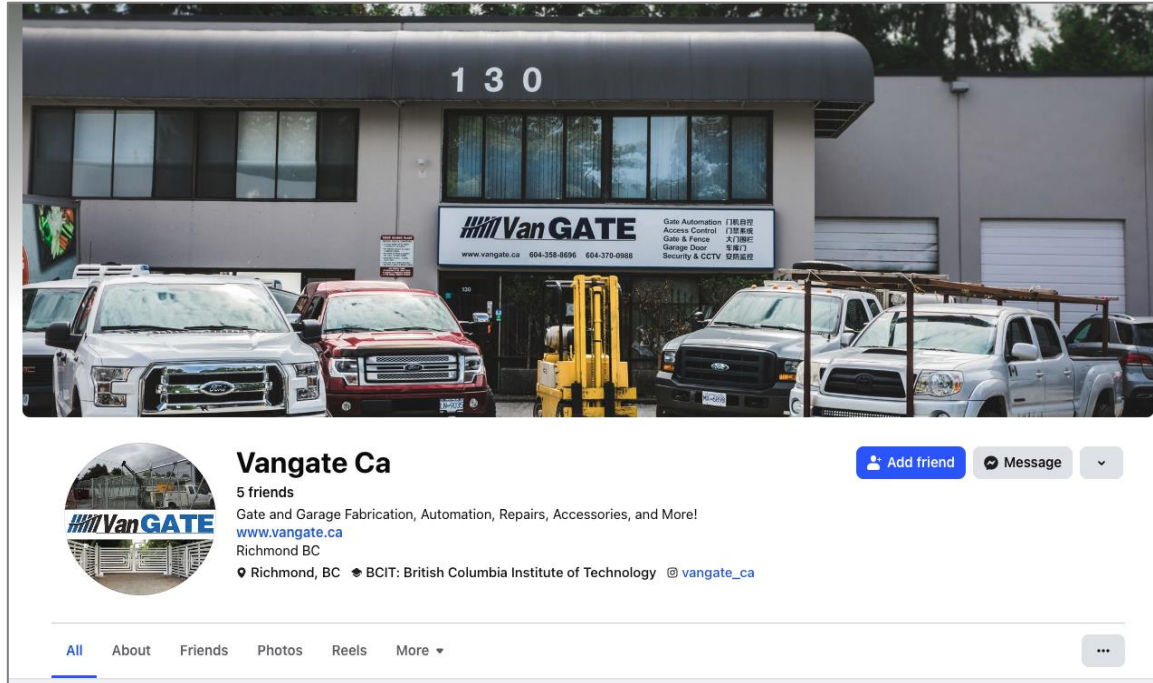
- ➔ Confirm that you (and any other key members of your leadership team) have administrative rights. At The BDC, we find that the GBP is often set up by another employee or outside contractor and once they leave or sever ties to the organization, it can prove difficult to sort out access rights.
- ➔ Confirm the information provided in your GBP and that all the links work.
- ➔ Carefully review your social channel links. You will need to change the links for FB and Linked In. The TikTok link goes to a placeholder with no posts. The Instagram link is broken.
- ➔ Encourage your customers to give you Google reviews. This can be part of the final stages of your sales process. Once the project is completed, send a follow-up email with a request for a review and a link.
- ➔ Respond to all reviews.



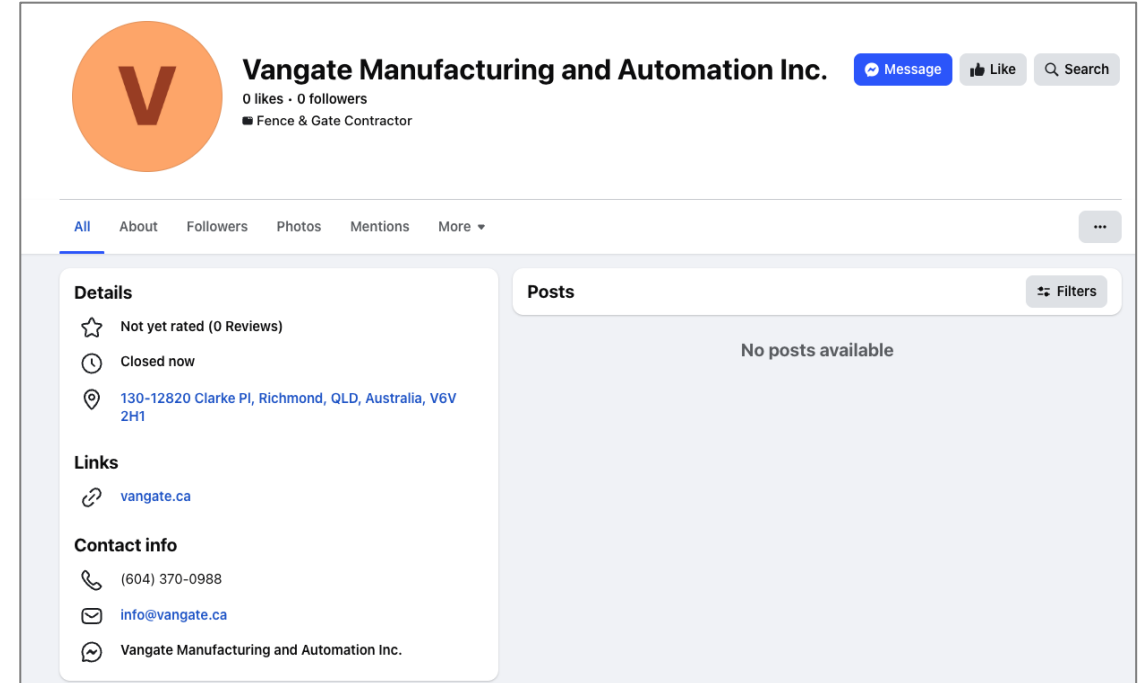
Your Facebook Profile



Facebook Personal Page for Vangate



Facebook Business Profile Page for Vangate



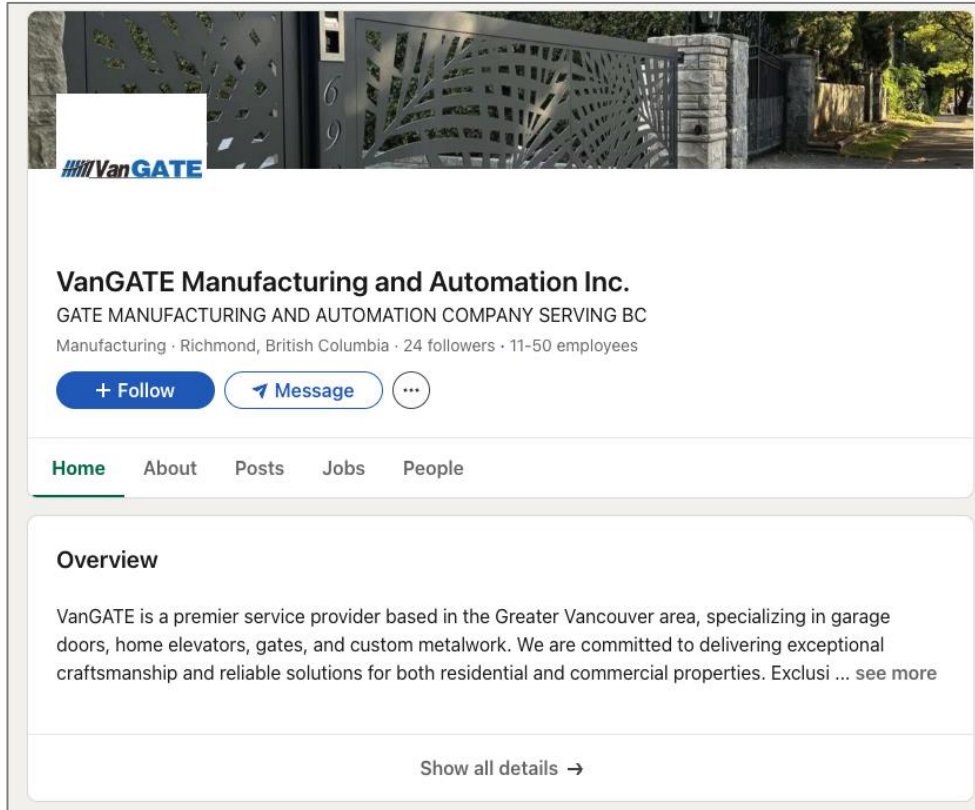
Observations and Recommendations:

- Your Google Business Profile links to a Facebook page that is set up as a personal page with 5 friends, as opposed to a business page (where it would have followers, not friends.)
- There does seem to be a Vangate Manufacturing business profile set up on Facebook - but the address information is incorrect.
- Review your profiles on Facebook and ensure you are set up properly as a business. Each of your employees may have personal FB accounts that can follow the business and then amplify the information from your business profile to their personal networks.

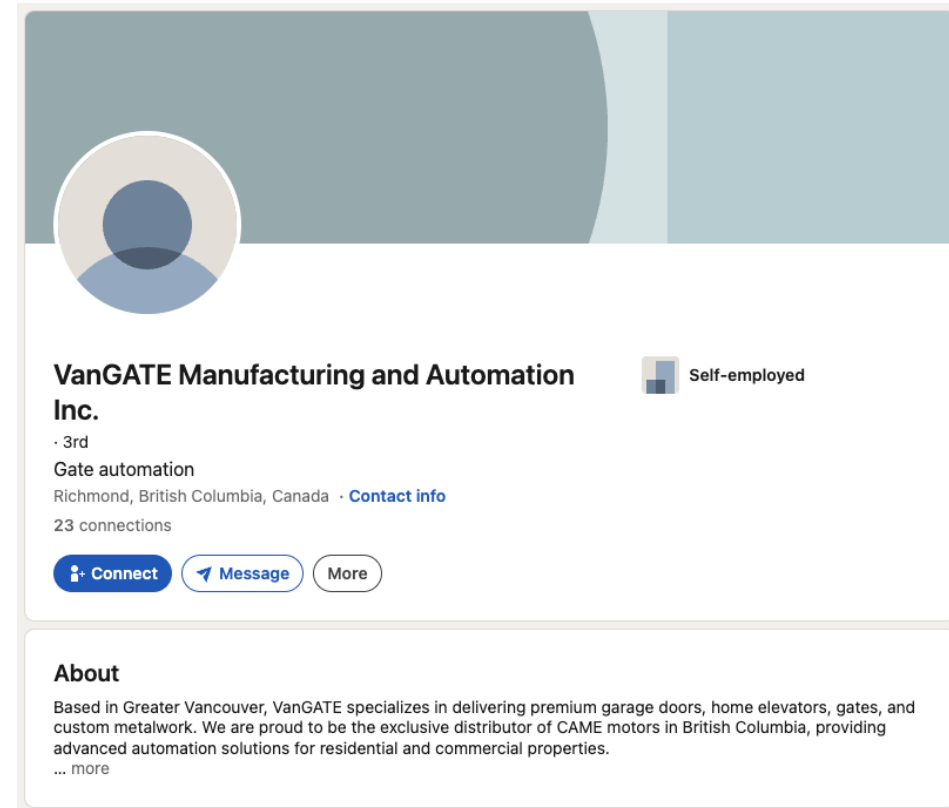
Your Linked In Profile



Linked in Business Profile Page for Vangate



Linked in Personal Page for Vangate



Observations and Recommendations:

- Similarly, your Google Business Profile links to a Linked IN profile that is set up as a personal page with 23 connections as opposed to a business page (where it would have followers, not connections.)
- Vangate Manufacturing does have a separate business profile set up on Linked In with 24 followers.
- Review your profiles on Linked IN and ensure you are set up properly as a business. Each of your employees may have personal Linked accounts that can follow the business and then amplify the information from your business profile to their personal networks.

Review Sites



	Vangate
Google Reviews	4.9/5,0 82 reviews
Glassdoor	2.0/5.0 2 ratings

Observations

- ➔ You have 82 reviews and a 4.9/5,0 rating on Google. We love that you take the time to respond to your reviews.
- ➔ You have 2 ratings on Glassdoor with an overall average of 2.0/5.0. Positive feedback includes friendly staff, a chance to learn, lots of technical stuff that they teach you; negative feedback is around lack of proper management and safety.

Recommendations

- ➔ Reviews are really important for SEO! Continue soliciting reviews and responding. You may want to build this into your sales process as you wrap up a project. Encourage your team members to give you ratings on Glassdoor and see if you can improve your overall rating.



04

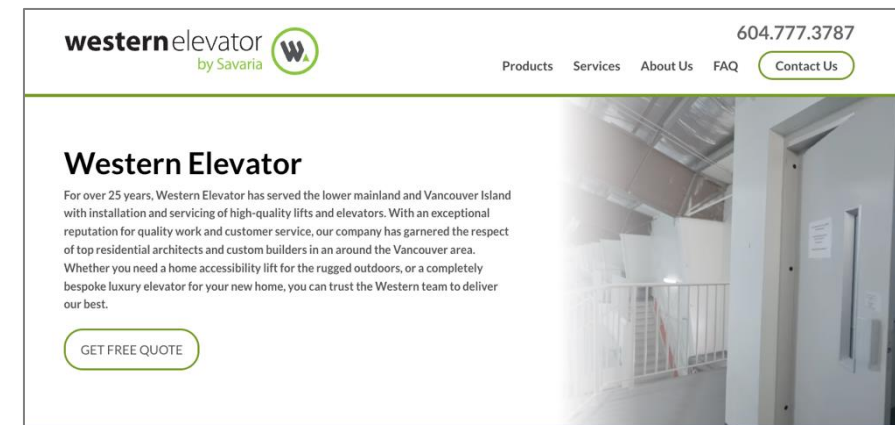
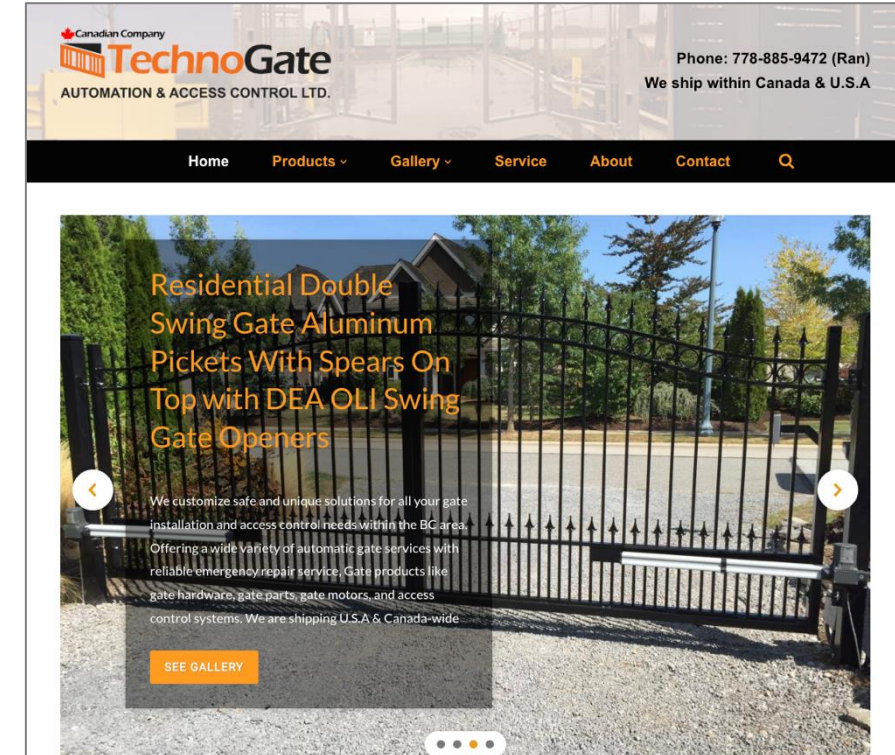
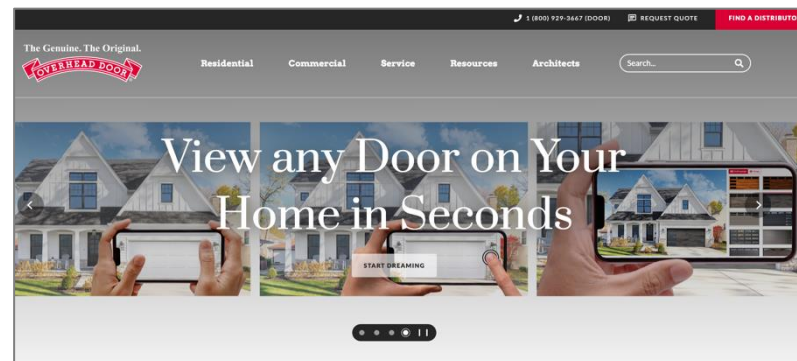
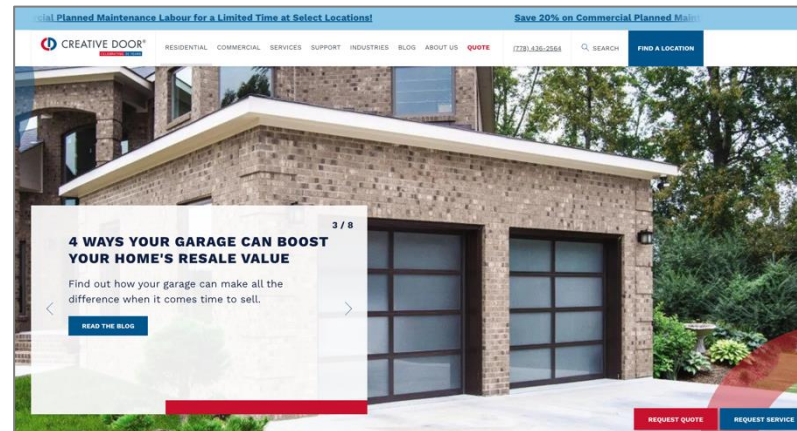
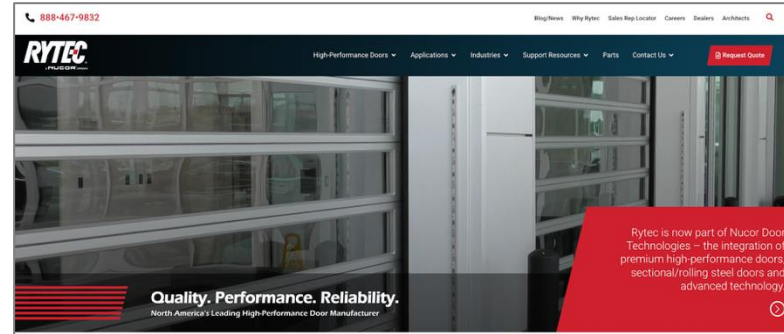
Competitive Digital Assessment

Competitor's Home Pages



Observations

- As noted, three of your competitors have websites with high authority scores (Rytec, Creative and Overhead).
- Review these websites carefully to understand their layout, how they build out SEO-rich content and showcase their competitive advantages.



Competitive Digital Assessment

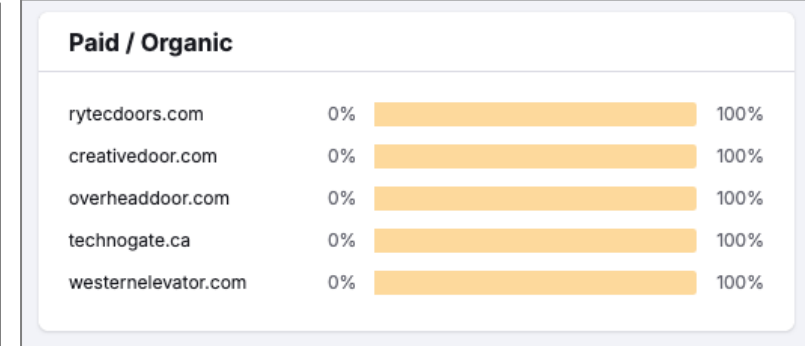
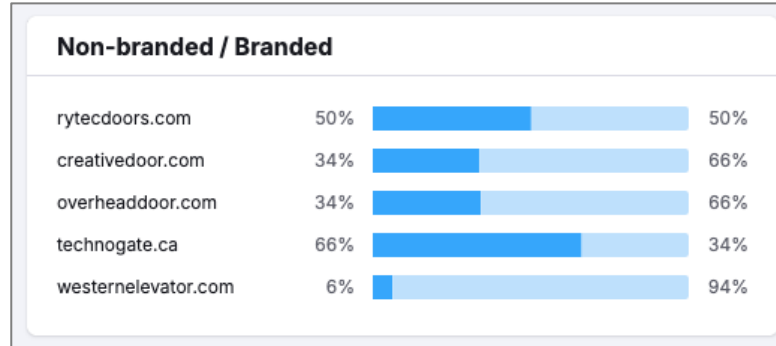
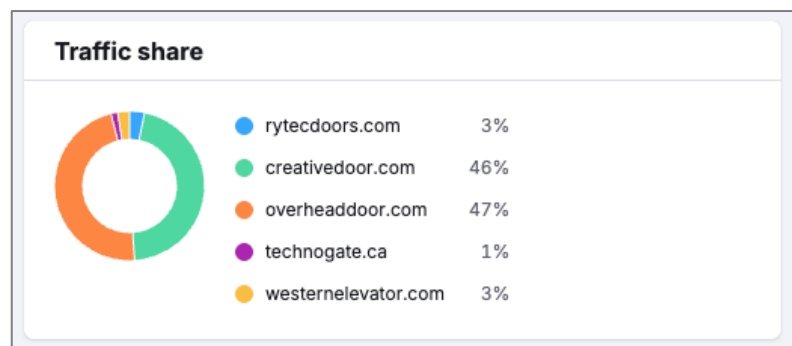


Category	<u>VanGATE</u>	<u>Rytec Doors</u>	<u>Creative Door Services</u>	<u>Overhead Door</u>	<u>Technogate</u>	<u>Western Elevator</u>
Company Type	Manufacturer, fabricator, installer, automation specialist	High-performance door manufacturer	Full-service door and loading dock provider	Global door manufacturer and distributor network	Gate automation supplier and installer	Elevator and accessibility lift specialist
Core Products	Gates, commercial doors, high-speed doors, loading docks, elevators, automation systems	High-speed industrial and commercial doors	Garage doors, overhead doors, loading docks, automatic entrances, service	Residential garage doors, commercial doors, dock equipment, openers	Automated gates, gate hardware, access control systems, barriers	Residential elevators, wheelchair lifts, stairlifts, platform lifts
Manufacturing Capability	Extensive in-house engineering and fabrication	Proprietary door manufacturing	Primarily distribution, installation and service	Large-scale manufacturer	Imports and distributes products from European manufacturers	Dealer/installer model
Primary Markets	Industrial, commercial, residential	Industrial, manufacturing, food processing, warehousing, cold storage	Commercial, industrial, residential, institutional	Residential, commercial, industrial	Residential and commercial property access control	Residential and commercial accessibility
Geographic Focus	British Columbia and Western Canada	North America	Western Canada	North America	Greater Vancouver and BC	British Columbia
Key Differentiator	Full vertical integration from design through manufacturing and installation	Specialized high-speed door expertise	Broad service footprint and maintenance network	Brand recognition and product breadth	Custom gate automation expertise and European hardware	Accessibility and home mobility specialization
High-Speed Door Offering	Yes	Core specialization	Yes	Yes	Limited	No
Gate Automation Offering	Major focus	No	Limited	Limited	Core specialization	No
Elevator / Lift Offering	Yes	No	No	No	No	Core specialization
Service & Maintenance	Yes	Dealer-based support	Extensive service network	Distributor network	Yes	Yes
Ideal Customer	Developers, industrial facilities, commercial property owners needing integrated solutions	Warehouses, manufacturing plants, cold storage, food processing facilities	Property managers, contractors, industrial operators	General contractors, developers, facility owners	Homeowners, strata, commercial facilities requiring secure access	Homeowners, builders, accessibility-focused projects

Technical Competitive Assessment



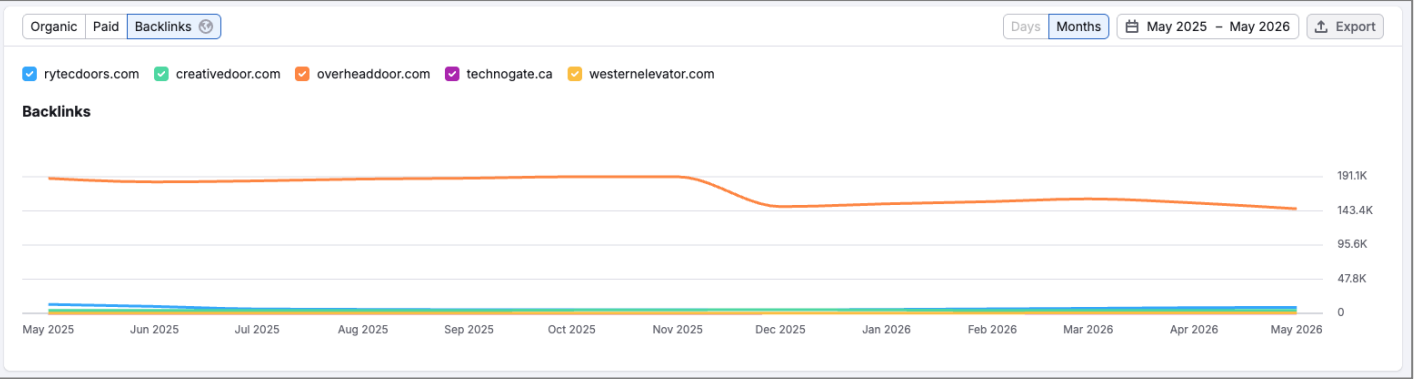
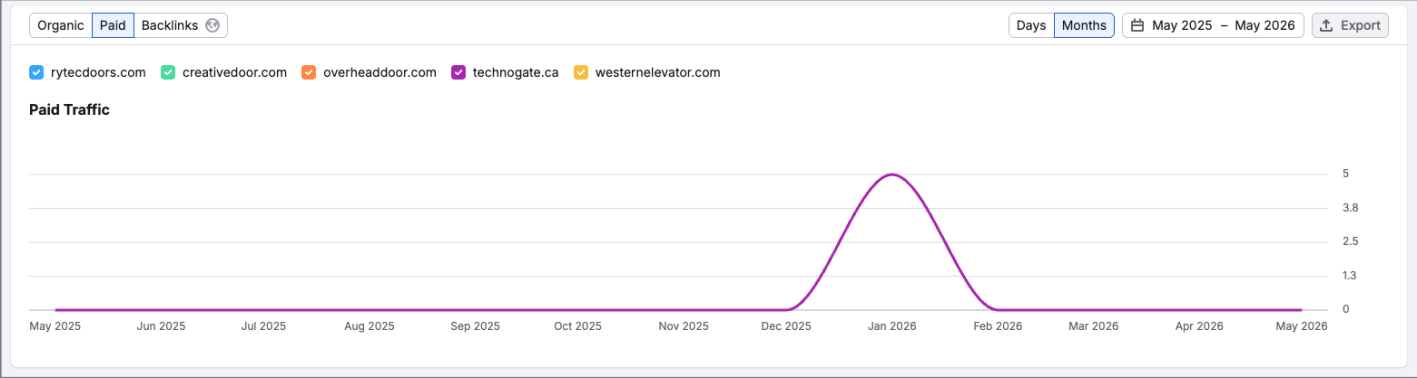
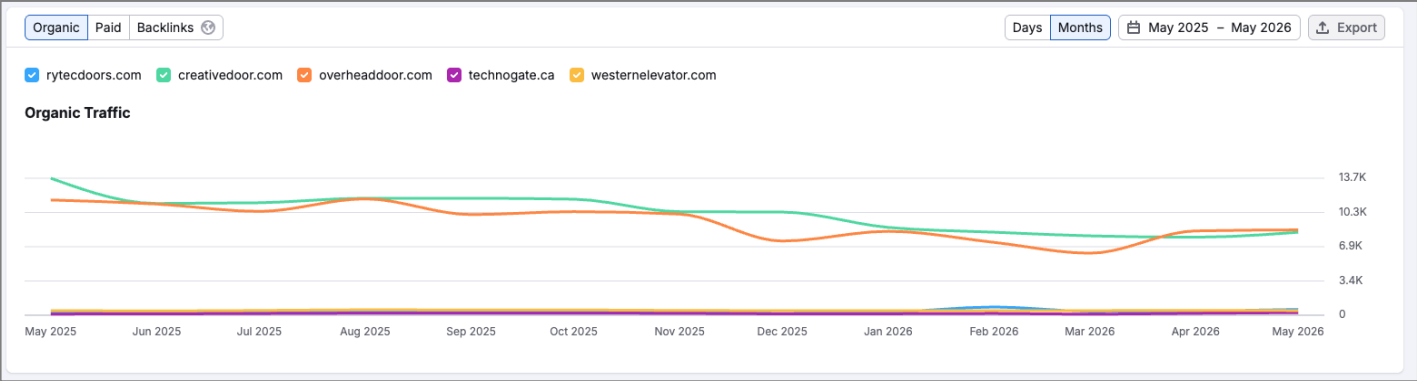
Domain	Authority score	Semrush Rank	Org. Traffic	Org. Keywords	Backlinks	Ref. Domains	Paid Keywords	Paid Traffic Cost
rytecdoors.com	31	288.1K ↑	580 ↑	1.1K ↓	8.4K	1.2K	0	\$0
creativetecdoor.com	31	31.3K ↑	8.3K ↑	2.5K ↓	4.1K	924	0	\$0
overheaddoor.com	42	30.4K ↑	8.5K ↑	3.8K ↓	146.3K	6.8K	0	\$0
technogate.ca	11	477.4K ↑	260 ↑	210 ↑	189	76	0	\$0
westernelevators.com	15	333.4K ↓	466 ↓	205 ↑	756	192	0	\$0



Observations and Recommendations

- For comparison, your Authority Score is 9.
- Three of your competitors have high Authority Scores which is correlated to SEO rich content and keywords, high traffic and a solid backlink strategy (Rytec, Creative and Overhead).
- Creative and Overhead have the lions share of traffic.
- There is a good mix of branded and non-branded traffic for all your competitors except Western Elevator, which has mostly branded traffic.
- None of your competitors are doing paid search.

Technical Competitive Assessment



Social Channels – Competitive Assessment



Observations and Recommendations

- ➔ All of your competitors, except Technogate, have their social media channels set up and for the most part, are using them quite effectively.
- ➔ They have amassed a significant following; posts are regular and on brand.
- ➔ Set up all of your social media channels as placeholders.
- ➔ Develop a content strategy with pillars of information around various topics – for example, the products, key projects, industry info and the team. Brainstorm with your team to develop a pipeline of ideas and build content with the help of AI or a contractor.

	Rytec Doors	Creative Door	Overhead Door	Technogate	Western Elevator (Savaria)
	1.5K followers May 28	4.4K followers May 28	12K followers May 28		4.3K followers May 28
	2038 followers May 28	1699 followers 2023	3476 followers (Texas) May 28	-	3651 followers May 28
	5K followers May 28	2K followers May 29	4K followers May 29		21K followers May 29
	971 subscribers 66 videos	87 subscribers 201 videos	6.49K subscribers 110 videos		

Competitive Assessment - Review Sites



	Rytec Doors	Creative Doors (Delta)	Overhead Door	Technogate	Western Elevator
Google Reviews	-	4.6/5.0 213 reviews	4.3-4.9/5.0 across its network	5.0/5.0 6 reviews	3.9/5.0 24 reviews
Glassdoor	2.9/5.0 20 ratings	3..2/5.0 23 ratings	3.8/5.0 364 ratings	-	-

Observations and Recommendations

- You are doing a great job with your Google reviews; keep an eye on what people are saying in their reviews of your competitors.
- Your competitors who are on Glassdoor have low ratings. Review these ratings to see what employees are saying – they may give you some ideas for improvement with your own team.



05

Overall Evaluations

Digital Landscape Report Card



Strategic area	Strength	Evolving (gaps identified)	Weakness	More info required
Website				
Home page		•		
Product/service pages		•		
Conversion and CTA's		•		
Technical considerations			•	
Performance monitoring		•		
SEO and keywords considerations			•	
Backlink strategy		•		
Social media				
Channels			•	
Consistency of posts			•	
Relevancy of posts			•	
Brand and value proposition				
Clear value proposition		•		
Quantity of online reviews		•		
Quality of online reviews		•		

Key Takeaways



Area of Focus	Action Items	Timeframe
Social	• Set up your social channels	0-1 month
	• Develop a content strategy for meaningful timely posts	6+ months
Reviews	• Build Google reviews into your sales process	1-3 months
	• Respond to your Google reviews	6+ months
Google Business Profile	• Confirm your access to your Google Business Profile page.	0-1 month
Website Performance	• Review your website assessment reports and deal with technical issues.	1-3+ months
Website User Experience	• Add copy to your homepage above the fold to better showcase your value proposition.	0-1 months
	• Develop stronger calls to action and pathways for each of your main customer segments.	1-3 months
	• Develop case studies to demonstrate your capabilities to your commercial customers.	3-6 months
	• Develop a clear and focused Why Us section.	1-3 months
	• Consider relaunching your blog.	6+ months
	• Consider an Employment page.	6+ months



Questions?



06

Next Steps

Next steps



Market Research Meeting

Meeting date:

TBD

Objective:

➔ Market research results will be presented to you during this one-hour meeting.

Preparation required:

➔ None

Thank you!

Jason Mann

Project Lead

BDC

250-212-2984

Jason.mann@bdc.ca

Jennifer Rikely

Business Consultant

BDC

60—838-4333

jennifer.rikely@bdc.ca

 BDC

 BDC_ca

 BDC

 BDC_ca

